

My method:

Collage is a form of surrealism, as Max Ernst defines "Collage is the noble conquest of the irrational, the coupling of two realities, irreconcilable in appearance, upon a plane which apparently does not suit them." (The Art Of Collage, 1).

Inspired by this reading, I wanted my work to couple multiple eclectic realities defined under the same words. To generate this work, I started with a list of Homonyms, thinking of words that had multiple meanings. For example, my work uses *gimp* as a subject, which either relates to BDSM communities or a derogatory term for having a limp. I situated my *gimp* on a *bank*, which was interpreted as either a financial institution or the side of a river, or both, depending on context. I gave my subject a *bat* which generated in either as a wooden weapon or a nocturnal animal depending on the vague context stated later in the prompt. Adding the homonym *wave* vaguely directed the scene to be calmer and friendlier, no matter which meaning, to greet or a ripple, was interpreted.

Through my research in surreal poetry I realized the throughline in the genre was to either polarize emotions in one circumstance or object, or to draw a throughline in emotions between contrasting circumstances or objects. For example, in *Meditations* by Charles Baudelaire, he writes "...choking fog has blanketed the town..." and "...in tattered clothes from heavens balconies..." to contrast states in one scene. In *Birth* by Georg Trakl, he unifies three different levels of ease with a thread of regeneration, writing "The cry of the woman in labor. The night troubles The boy's sleep with black wings, With snow, which falls with ease out of the purple clouds." Steve Roggenbuck represents love and death, happy and sad simultaneously, speaking "i want your cold pointless hands. i want to put flowers in your cold pointless mouth." There is also the surreal in contrasting the possible with the impossible, where Bunny Rogers writes "Pull out the sword and break it, like bread". These writings inspired my scenes.

My first scene is paradise, though infested by locust and bats, the gimp is not interpreted as disabled. My second scene shows a conflict, as driven by conflicting prompts, a neutral. My third scene paints a surreal picture of victory and disappointment, with a gimp interpreted as both the BDSM creature and a disabled person, head arched in exhaustion.